

FL-05: The Prompt Ladder

FlyRank General AI Fluency – Week 2

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1. Assignment Overview

The Prompt Ladder exercise is designed to build a practical understanding of iterative prompt engineering. Starting from a weak, unrefined baseline prompt, this assignment progressively adds layers of clarity, context, structure, and constraints across five versions. Each rung of the ladder documents the exact change made, the resulting improvement in AI output quality, and the limitations that remained — culminating in a final, reusable prompt template and a summary of key takeaways about effective prompt design.

2. Weak Baseline Prompt

Prompt

[Insert weak baseline prompt here]

AI Output (Representative Excerpt)

[Insert representative excerpt of the AI's output for the weak baseline prompt here]

3. Version 1

Layer Added: [Insert Layer Added — e.g., Role/Persona]

Updated Prompt

[Insert updated prompt for Version 1]

Output Excerpt

[Insert output excerpt for Version 1]

Notes

- What changed in the prompt: [Insert what changed in the prompt]
- What improved in the output: [Insert what improved in the output]
- What still failed: [Insert what still failed]

- What I would try next: [Insert what you would try next]

4. Version 2

Layer Added: [Insert Layer Added — e.g., Context/Background]

Updated Prompt

[Insert updated prompt for Version 2]

Output Excerpt

[Insert output excerpt for Version 2]

Notes

- What changed in the prompt: [Insert what changed in the prompt]
- What improved in the output: [Insert what improved in the output]
- What still failed: [Insert what still failed]
- What I would try next: [Insert what you would try next]

5. Version 3

Layer Added: [Insert Layer Added — e.g., Output Format/Structure]

Updated Prompt

[Insert updated prompt for Version 3]

Output Excerpt

[Insert output excerpt for Version 3]

Notes

- What changed in the prompt: [Insert what changed in the prompt]

- What improved in the output: [Insert what improved in the output]
- What still failed: [Insert what still failed]
- What I would try next: [Insert what you would try next]

6. Version 4

Layer Added: [Insert Layer Added — e.g., Constraints/Examples]

Updated Prompt

[Insert updated prompt for Version 4]

Output Excerpt

[Insert output excerpt for Version 4]

Notes

- What changed in the prompt: [Insert what changed in the prompt]
- What improved in the output: [Insert what improved in the output]
- What still failed: [Insert what still failed]
- What I would try next: [Insert what you would try next]

7. Version 5

Layer Added: [Insert Layer Added — e.g., Tone/Refinement]

Updated Prompt

[Insert updated prompt for Version 5]

Output Excerpt

[Insert output excerpt for Version 5]

Notes

- What changed in the prompt: [Insert what changed in the prompt]
- What improved in the output: [Insert what improved in the output]
- What still failed: [Insert what still failed]
- What I would try next: [Insert what you would try next]

8. Version Comparison Summary

The table below summarizes the progression of the Prompt Ladder across all versions.

Version	Layer Added	Key Improvement
Baseline	None	[Insert summary]
Version 1	[Insert layer]	[Insert summary]
Version 2	[Insert layer]	[Insert summary]
Version 3	[Insert layer]	[Insert summary]
Version 4	[Insert layer]	[Insert summary]
Version 5	[Insert layer]	[Insert summary]

9. Final Reusable Prompt

The final prompt below consolidates all effective layers identified through the iterative process into a single, reusable template.

[Insert final reusable prompt template here]

10. Key Learning

- [Insert key learning point 1]
- [Insert key learning point 2]
- [Insert key learning point 3]
- [Insert key learning point 4]
- [Insert key learning point 5 — optional]
- [Insert key learning point 6 — optional]

11. Conclusion

[Insert one short paragraph explaining how iterative prompt refinement improved the quality of AI responses across the versions documented above.]